FEATURES THAT MAKE YOUR CAMERA TRULY DIGITAL

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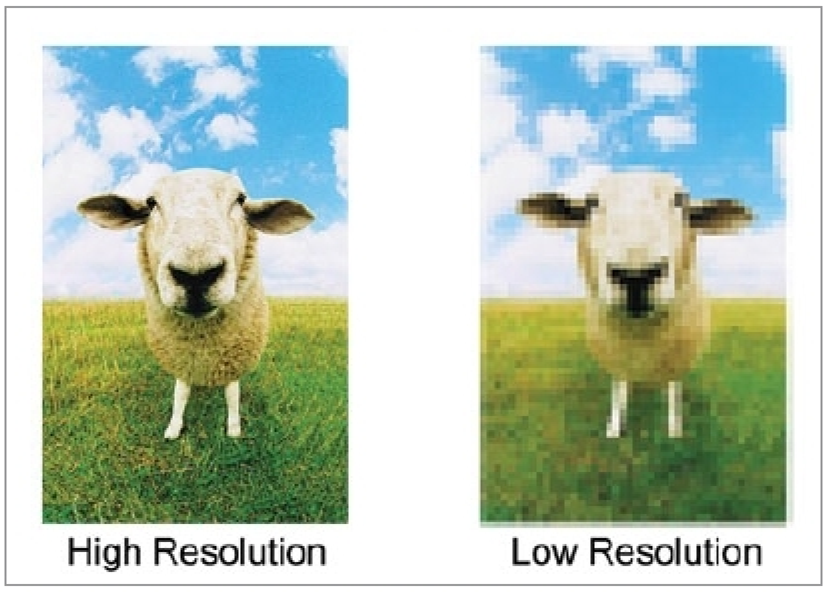
To keep your memories safe, you need a camera. If you want to capture images that have details, or that can be captured in the dark, choose a digital camera that offers the required features. This article aims to help you find the perfect camera for your applications.

Key features of a digital camera are screen size, resolution, memory, flash type, burst mode, optical zoom, battery life, sensor size and lens. A good digital camera has a large sensor, fast aperture and incredibly sharp lenses.

Resolution. Choose a camera with at least 12-megapixel resolution—higher the number of pixels, higher the resolution. Picture size is measured by horizontal and vertical pixels, as in 1280 × 960.

You can change the resolution of the pictures as per your needs. For example, set the resolution to a low level to produce images that are ready to be emailed or used on a website.

Inbuilt flash. This is a must while choosing a digital camera. You can opt for extra light for shooting indoors or in low-light conditions.



Difference between high resolution (left) and low resolution (right) (Credit: www.intouchlabels.com)

Image without flash (left) and with flash (right) (Credit: https://profoto.com)

Inbuilt flash also helps with red eye reduction, using two flashes. The first contracts the iris so that the eye does not reflect much light with the second.

Lenses. The standard range for the lenses is 18mm to 55mm. A digital camera with 48 times zoom is fit for normal usage.

There are two types of zoom lenses: digital and optical. Optical zoom measures the actual increase in the focal length of the lens. (Focal length is the distance between the centre of the lens and the image sensor.) By moving the lens farther from the image sensor inside the camera, zoom increases because a small part of the scene strikes the image sensor. This results in magnification.

Digital zoom, on the other hand, is a technology where the camera shoots the photo and then crops and magnifies it to create an artificial close-up photo. This requires enlarging or removing individual pixels, which can ruin the image quality.

Continuous shooting modes. There is a time lag between when the shoot button is pressed and when the camera can take another photo. Burst mode, or continuous shooting mode, lets you take several photos/shots in a row. This also helps in taking shots in motion.

In time lapse mode, you can set up your camera on a tripod to take a series of pictures over a period.

Majority of consumer and high-end digital cameras also have a movie mode.

ISO. Light sensitivity is determined by ISO factor. Higher the ISO setting determined by the aperture, the less light a camera needs to take a good image. Light sensitivity helps in auto-focus and